



MAKERERE UNIVERSITY

POLICY FOR MAKERERE UNIVERSITY STUDENT WORK SCHEME

OCTOBER 2021

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Commitment to hands-on education

Makerere University is committed to giving its students an education that prepares them for employment within the University and the outside world. The University strives to provide to its students, the education that will enable them to explore career options, discover their strengths and weaknesses and experience how academic learning applies to the world of work. This effort is premised on the understanding that employers worldwide, prefer to hire University graduates who have acquired soft skills, a positive work ethic, hands-on technical work experience and ability to multi task.

1.2 Amelioration of the Cost of Education

In addition to providing a learning experience, student employment shall provide opportunities for students on the work scheme to finance their education while at the University. It is also envisaged that the work force provided by the students through the work scheme shall lower the cost of running the University business.

1.3 Guidance on Procedure

1.3.1 The students and their supervisors and other staff shall be required to read, understand and adhere to the contents of this policy.

1.3.2 It shall be the duty of staff in the Coordination Office to popularize and create awareness of this Policy amongst all other stakeholders.

1.3.3 In the event of violation of any provision of this policy and the rules of procedure, the University reserves the right to cancel the Work Scheme award to any student.

1.4 Health and Safety

The students work scheme shall be guided by the provisions of Health and safety laws of Uganda. In order to adhere to health and safety requirements, all students employed under the scheme shall be supervised at all times by a member of staff of the University department or external institution under which such student is employed.

1.5 Sexual Harassment

1.5.1 All students under the work scheme shall be governed by the Makerere University Policy and Regulations against Sexual Harassment, as amended in 2018. The student employees shall enjoy the same protection under the said policy as other University employees.

1.5.2 All sexual harassment complaints arising as a result of the implementation of this Policy shall be handled in accordance with the provisions enshrined in the Makerere University Policy and Regulations against Sexual Harassment.

1.6 Student Employee Responsibilities

1.6.1 A student on the Work Scheme shall be required to:

- (a) use the job as an opportunity to gain marketable skills and to establish a good work record;
- (b) know his/ her job description in order to ensure that the duties as described are well performed;
- (c) perform work duties in a professional manner;
- (d) work with a cooperative and positive attitude;
- (e) Adhere to any confidentiality set forth from time to time.
- (f) promptly and consistently seek guidance from the Supervisor whenever necessary;
- (g) ensure that appropriate assistance is sought from the Lecturers and/or the supervisor incase problems in class work arise as a result of being employed under the Work Scheme;
- (h) uphold good work ethics/discipline such as time management, response to job assignments, dress code, read and understand rules/policies/regulations;
- (i) guard against negative tendencies such as drug and alcohol abuse, misuse of institutional property such as the computers and telephones;
- (j) initiate the termination process if it is deemed necessary, especially for the good of the student's study programme;
- (k) do any other responsibility that may be legitimately identified by the employer/supervisor and assigned to the student.

2.0 Relevant National Laws and Institutional Policies/ Regulations

2.1 In establishing and running the Students Work Scheme, special attention shall be paid to the following national laws, policies and guidelines as they may be amended from time to time:

- (a) The Constitution of the Republic of Uganda, 1995;
- (b) The Universities and Other Tertiary Institutions Act, (2001) as amended;
- (c) The Employment Act 2006;
- (d) The Occupational Safety and Health Act, 2006; and,
- (e) Any other dispute/conflict/resolution related regulations.

2.2 The scheme shall also be implemented in compliance with the existing University Policies and Regulations, including:

- (a) The Makerere University Human Resource Manual, 2009 as amended;
- (b) The Makerere University Students Regulations 2015;
- (c) The Makerere University Policy and Regulations Against Sexual Harassment, as amended in 2018;
- (d) The Makerere University Communications Policy 2013;
- (e) The Makerere University Policy on Students with Disabilities, 2014;
- (f) The Makerere University Students' Regulations SI No. 37 of 2015;
- (g) The Makerere University Guidelines for Operation of the Semester/ Credit Unit System for Undergraduate Programs;
- (h) Other relevant University Policies

3.0 Eligibility for the Student Work Scheme

3.1 Academic qualification for the Work Scheme

3.1.1 For a student to be awarded a work scheme job, he/she shall:

- (a) be admitted for an eligible study programme as determined by the Academic Registrar;
- (b) be registered for at least six (6) credits each semester;
- (c) possess abilities, knowledge and skills to suit the position applied for;
- (d) be able to work for the minimum prescribed hours per week without jeopardizing his/ her academic programme;
- (e) meet the minimum academic standing of normal progress and a CGPA of at least 2.8.

3.2 Term of the Work Scheme Placement

3.2.1 Every Work Scheme award shall be valid for a maximum of one academic year, running from 1st July to 30th June of the following year.

3.2.2 Any student who would like to apply for the same position in the following academic year, shall have his/her eligibility re-evaluated to ensure that the applicant still meets the job requirements.

3.3 Non-discrimination

3.3.1 Makerere University, in running its programs and activities, does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, nationality, disability, age, religion, gender, political affiliation, creed, marital status and other differences.

3.3.2 The responsibility for the protection and implementation of this commitment extends to students, staff, contractors, affiliate institutions, members of management and all the organs of the University.

3.3.3 The Students Work Scheme shall be implemented in strict compliance with the principles of non-discrimination.

3.4 Students with Disabilities

Special consideration shall be given to students with disabilities in areas which are specifically suitable for them.

4.0 The Administrative Structure of the Student Work Scheme

4.1 Coordination and Reporting

- 4.1.1 There shall be a Coordination Office which shall be responsible for all activities and programs under the Student Work Scheme.
- 4.1.2 The Coordination Office shall be headed by a Coordinator at salary scale M5 assisted by three Assistant Coordinators at M6.2 Scale.
- 4.1.3 The Coordinator and Assistant Coordinators shall be employed on contractual basis.
- 4.1.4 The Coordination Office shall report to the office of the Vice-Chancellor.

4.2 Coordination Responsibilities

- 4.2.1 **Human Resources:** There shall be an Assistant Coordinator to guide the Scheme on issues of human resources. This officer shall be responsible for coordinating placement of students in academic and administrative units of the University and handle placements that may be secured in organizations outside the University.
- 4.2.2 **Academic Affairs:** There shall be an Assistant Coordinator to guide the Scheme on Academic matters such as Rules and Regulations for academic programs, and verification of academic suitability of applicants to the scheme.
- 4.2.3 **Students Affairs:** There shall be an Assistant Coordinator working with the office of the Dean of Students, to guide the Scheme on general students' life, needy students and students with disabilities.

4.3 Duties of officers of the Work Scheme

- 4.3.1 The Coordinator of the Students Work Scheme, assisted by the Assistant Coordinators and other relevant organs of the University shall:
 - (a) coordinate and ensure the effective implementation of this Policy;
 - (b) Handle the job application and placement processes under this Policy including:
 - i. identifying job opportunities for applicants;
 - ii. receiving applications;
 - iii. processing appointment letters;
 - iv. keeping records of the beneficiaries;
 - v. carrying out periodic reviews; and
 - vi. attending to all other administrative aspects of the Scheme;

- (c) track work study eligibility and issue work study job referrals;
- (d) provide employment and career related services;
- (e) issue job referrals to those seeking student employment outside the University and approve resumes for all student employment applicants;
- (f) carry out student background checks;
- (g) profile student workforce and make final authorization for them to work;
- (h) make sure that students maintain their eligibility to work;
- (i) evaluate every job duty, determine pay rate and track earnings of the students' workers;
- (j) in liaison with departmental supervisors, monitor and evaluate the work of the students' employees;
- (k) resolve work-related problems;
- (l) handle the termination process for the work scheme awards;
- (m) handle any other issue relevant or incidental to the running of the Work Scheme.

5.0 Determination of mode of payment

- 5.1 Payment shall be made in respect of the actual amount of work done, time spent on the job and the pre-agreed payment structure for the given position. This process shall be managed by the internal Unit or external institution providing the job and the Coordination Office.
- 5.2 The Scheme may initially start on a volunteer basis until it is fully established with a financial base to pay specified allowances/salaries.

6.0 Establishment of Functional Institutional Linkages

- 6.1 In addition to Work Scheme vacancies in the University, the Scheme shall strive to establish functional institutionalized linkages with Local Governments, Local Agencies, Private Organizations and other Universities, Government Agencies.
- 6.2 Considering that creation of linkages is a procedural and continuous process, establishment of functional institutional linkages shall be one of the key result areas of the office of the Coordinator of the Work Scheme.
- 6.3 The Work Scheme Coordination office shall work with the assistance of the office of the Vice-Chancellor and other relevant organs of the University to look out for possible functional institutional linkages.

7.0 Areas and Specialties for Work Scheme Deployment

The Work Scheme Coordination office shall keep engaging all the departments and units of the University and, where possible, external entities in order to generate areas and specialties where the students on the work scheme can be deployed and on what terms.

8.0 Review of Policies relevant to the Work Scheme

While the Work Scheme is established in accordance with the existing national and institutional policies and regulations as indicated in Section 2.0 of this policy, there shall be periodic reviews of the policies and regulations to keep pace with the changing situational circumstances of the higher education sector, employment sector and other relevant sectors in the country.

9.0 Generation of Philanthropic Projects and Income for the Scheme

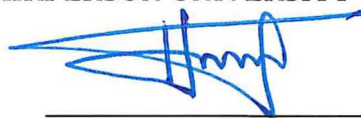
- 9.1 The University shall strive to generate philanthropic income through levies on operational projects to augment the resource base for funding the Students Work Scheme.
- 9.2 The Work Scheme Coordination office, in conjunction with other organs of the University and well-wishers, shall initiate and write proposals to reputable organizations for possible philanthropic support to the work scheme.

Approved during the 153rd meeting of Council held on 6th October 2021.



Lorna Magara

CHAIRPERSON UNIVERSITY COUNCIL



Yusuf Kiranda

SECRETARY TO COUNCIL



MAKERERE UNIVERSITY

RULES OF PROCEDURE FOR THE STUDENT WORK SCHEME

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RULES OF PROCEDURE FOR THE STUDENT WORK SCHEME

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1. Introduction

WHEREAS the University Council, in line with Section 40(2) of the Universities and Other Tertiary Institutions Act, 2001 (as amended), approved the Policy for Makerere University Student Work Scheme;

AND WHEREAS the Work Scheme recognises that Student Employment is an important step in pursuit of personal and professional growth of the students engaged in acquiring education as a lifetime investment;

AND WHEREAS the Work Scheme aims at assisting students to get some financial stability that would enable them to pursue their studies without much stress and also instill an ethical orientation and positive attitude in them towards work;

AND WHEREAS, at the institutional level, the Work Scheme shall improve the already existing relationships between the student and non-student communities of the University, while externally exposing students to professional role models and expanding their professional networks and relationships;

NOW THEREFORE, these Rules of Procedure, which shall be guided by the existing national laws and institutional regulations/policies (as they may be amended from time to time) and the principles of good governance, professionalism, accountability, effectiveness, discipline, integrity, impartiality, affirmative action and transparency, are hereby established as the blue print to operationalize the Makerere University Student Work Scheme Policy.

2. Eligibility for the Student Work Scheme

- 1) For a student to participate in the Student Work Scheme, he/she shall meet the following requirements:
 - a) be full-time undergraduate or post-graduate student enrolled on an eligible study programme as determined by the University Senate;
 - b) be registered for at least six (6) credits each semester;
 - c) be a full time registered student;
 - d) possess abilities, knowledge, and skills to suit the position applied for;
 - e) be able to work for the minimum prescribed hours per week without jeopardizing his/ her academic programme;
 - f) meet the minimum academic standing of normal progress with a CGPA of at least 2.8;and,

g) has never been convicted of any disciplinary or criminal offence.

2) A student on exchange program shall not be eligible for this Scheme.

3. Job identification

- 1) At the beginning of each academic year, the Work Scheme Coordination Office shall consult the Units of the University and other external employers for possible job openings and where applicable the source of funding for the jobs.
- 2) The job openings identified shall be notified to the Head of the Coordination Office for approval.
- 3) The Accounting Officer or the responsible officer in respect of external placements as the case may be, shall confirm availability of financial resources for this purpose.
- 4) The University Units and external institutions shall, in liaison with the Coordination Office, formulate job descriptions and the relevant qualifications (if any) and forward them to the Coordination office.
- 5) The available job openings shall then be listed by the Coordination Office for advertising.

4. Advertising

The available jobs shall be advertised on the Student Work Scheme web page and any other platform accessible to the student community, clearly indicating the type and number of jobs, the required qualifications, the Unit or external institution under which the job falls and any other necessary requirements and information.

5. Application

Applicants, while applying, shall be required to comply with all the requirements made in advertisement.

6. Candidate Selection, Appointment, Placement and Induction

- 1) The candidate selection process shall be coordinated by the Coordination Office which shall accord exceptional attention to students with disability and female applicants in light of their special needs, in order to ensure fair competition in the recruitment process.
- 2) All applications for placements under this scheme shall be addressed to the Head of the Coordination Office.
- 3) Selections shall be spearheaded by the Coordination Office in consultation with the University Unit or external institution concerned.

- 4) The Student Work Scheme office shall then formally invite the shortlisted candidates for interviews.
- 5) At the interview, the University Unit or external institution seeking to employ the student worker, shall provide the lead in consideration of the technical aspects related to the requirements of the job and the performance of the candidate(s) at the interview.
- 6) The best candidate(s) for the job, once identified, shall be issued with an employment offer in writing by the Coordination Office in line with the Policy for Makerere University Student Work Scheme and these Rules of Procedure.
- 7) The offer (appointment letter) shall indicate the position appointed to, job description, pay rate, starting and final date of the offer (which shall not exceed 12 months from July 1), working hours per day/week, reporting procedures and any other relevant information.
- 8) Before taking up the offer, the student worker offered the job shall be required to accept in writing, the offer and terms of employment indicated therein.
- 9) The said acceptance shall be in form of a letter written or a form duly filled and signed by the selected candidate.
- 10) An offer shall be taken up within a period of 10 working days, failure of which that offer shall be deemed declined in which case an offer shall be made to the next best applicant. If this is unsuccessful, then the position shall be subjected to a repeat of the selection process.
- 11) It shall be the responsibility of the University Unit or external institution where the student-worker is placed, to conduct an induction exercise aimed at explaining the details of the work and the work place requirements to the student-worker and notifying the Coordination Office of the date of commencement of work.
- 12) After the induction, or during the induction, where the induction is protracted, the selected candidate shall be placed at the most appropriate point of entry into the University Unit or external institution, and introduced to the work for which he/she was selected.
- 13) As part of the induction, the student-worker shall be allocated a supervisor who shall:
 - a) Be responsible for the professional mentorship of the student worker;
 - b) Directly supervise the work of the student-worker during his/ her placement;
 - c) Assess the performance of the student-worker and advise the University Unit or external institution, as the case may be, accordingly;
 - d) Ensure that the student worker is accorded all the support and guidance needed to perform his/ her duties;

- e) Ensure consistent and efficient attendance of the student worker to his/ her duties;
- f) Provide a conducive working environment for the student worker;
- g) Verify and sign the student worker's time sheets. It shall be the responsibility of the student worker to accurately complete and submit the timesheets;
- h) Assist the student worker in processing his/ her entitlements;
- i) Regulate the level of access of the student-worker to institutional information to ensure sufficient access without compromising confidentiality;
- j) Submit a report about the tenure of duty of the student worker to the Coordination Office at the end of the contract;
- k) Do any other thing that is necessary for the appropriate mentorship of the student-worker in line with his/ her terms of appointment and career aspirations.

7. Protection of academic progress, work ethic, and supervision during employment.

In order to ensure that the student-workers' academic progress is protected, the work ethic promoted and supervision enhanced, the student workers shall:

- 1) Work for a maximum of four hours a day (or 20 hours a week) during time that does not conflict with their classes, examinations, tests and any other academic program related to the student worker's course. In case of a conflict of academic programs and work duties, the academic program shall prevail;
- 2) ensure continued academic excellence during the employment period;
- 3) diligently do all the work assigned to them by their supervisors as provided for in the job offer;
- 4) strictly follow and adhere to the work place dress code, the institutional procedures and code of conduct;
- 5) refrain from prohibited practices like alcoholism and drug abuse, bullying, fighting, nepotism, absenteeism, sexual harassment, unsatisfactory performance, or any other behavior deemed inappropriate or not permitted in the work place;
- 6) be required to work closely with their supervisors to ensure that all job responsibilities and work hours are clearly understood and, where necessary, to receive constant mentorship from the supervisors;
- 7) Any issues/matters that may make the student worker unable to attend to his/her duties shall immediately be reported to the supervisor for permission or guidance.
- 8) Commitments from employment or work schedules shall not be accepted as valid reasons for absence from class, uncompleted classwork, late submission of class assignments, or poor academic performance.

8. Payment Rates and Procedures

- 1) Remuneration shall be in form of allowances and any other forms of remuneration as shall be determined by Council from time to time.
- 1) Student workers shall be paid per hour worked evidenced by a time sheet, at rates commensurate with work done and proposed by the Coordination Office and approved by University Management.

- 2) The Payment request form shall be duly completed and approved, with the supporting timesheet.
- 3) The student-workers' salary shall be initiated by the Unit where the student worker is deployed through the Coordination Office and processed on a monthly basis by the office of the University Bursar. It shall be the responsibility of the Units and the Coordination Office to ensure that payments are initiated and submitted for payment in a timely manner. In case of external placements, the Coordination Office shall be responsible for liaising with supervisors to ensure the timely payment of student-workers' allowances.
- 4) Student workers shall be paid through their bank accounts and their payments shall comply with the relevant laws of Uganda, including taxation laws, where applicable.
- 5) Student workers may be paid holiday, vacation, sick leave, unemployment insurance, medical benefits or any other benefits at the discretion of the employer. For avoidance of doubt, the said incentives shall not be mandatory since the student-workers will be paid for actual hours worked.
- 6) Student workers shall be exempted from processes/activities of the Units/ external institutions where they are employed in which the student-workers may be deemed to have conflict(s) of interest.

9. Grievance Resolution

- 1) Whenever conflict arises between student employees and their employers, every effort shall be made to satisfactorily resolve the conflict within the employing Unit.
- 2) In case the deploying Unit or external institution is unable to resolve the matter, it shall be referred to the Dean of Students who shall then appoint a committee to look into the matter and make a final decision within fourteen (14) days.

10. Procedures for Contract Termination

- 1) Where termination occurs as a result of the expiry of the contract, there may be no requirement, on either side, for giving notice.
- 2) When there is reason for resignation, the student-worker shall be required to give notice of, at least two weeks, through the Supervisor and the Head of the Unit to the Head of the Coordination Office.
- 3) Termination of contract by the employer for good cause, including elimination of the job slot from the Unit or external institution, shall be communicated in writing to the student worker, two weeks before termination or as circumstances would dictate, giving reason(s) why the contract is being terminated.

- 4) In case of misconduct, the Head of the Unit shall constitute a disciplinary committee of three employees at the level of Officer or above to handle the matter. This disciplinary committee shall ensure that the student worker is accorded a fair hearing and that all the rules of natural justice are duly complied with.
 - a) The Disciplinary Committee may issue any of or a combination of the following punishments as it deems fit:
 - i. Verbal caution
 - ii. Written warning
 - iii. Suspension
 - iv. Termination of employment
 - b) The decision of the Disciplinary Committee shall not be subject to the grievance resolution process.
- 5) Upon expiry of the contract or termination, the student worker shall be required to hand over all institutional property and ensure an orderly exit from the Unit of placement.

11. Other issues incidental to the Work Scheme

- 1) Student workers and their supervisors shall be protected against retaliatory tendencies from each other.
- 2) Student workers may be trained on the job in soft skills and other job related skills.
- 3) The student workers' safety concerns shall be handled like any other worker in the Unit/University.

12. Implementation of these rules.

Implementation of these Regulations primarily extends to Students, staff, contractors, affiliate institutions, members of management and all the organs of the University

13. Review of the Regulations

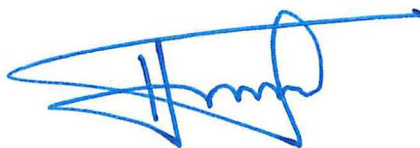
These regulations will be reviewed as and when the need for such review arises.

Approved during the 153rd meeting of Council held on 6th October 2021.



Lorna Magara

CHAIRPERSON UNIVERSITY COUNCIL



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SECRETARY TO COUNCIL